RED RUFFED LEMUR

Varecia rubra

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UNITED STATES DEPT. OF AGRI.

This animal is a teacher, not an attraction.

The keeper guides.
You observe. Do not touch.

Cameras in use. Federal penalties apply.

What can it see, hear, or feel?
It smells scent marks, listens for barking alarms, and uses sharp eyes to judge branch to branch.

Where does it live — and why?
It lives only in one rainforest corner of Madagascar, where tall trees carry fruit all year.

How does it send messages?
It gives loud barking calls to warn of danger and roars with the group to claim its home.

What does it do when something changes?
When a predator is near, it calls out, moves quietly together, and hides in the thick trees.

How does it learn?
Babies follow their mother, watch which trees hold ripe fruit, and learn alarm calls early in life.

How does it have babies?
A mother builds a high nest and has two or three babies; other adults help guard them.

What are its limits?
It needs a large, healthy rainforest. With so little left, it is critically endangered.

What does this teach us?
An animal that depends on one small forest teaches us how fragile an environment can be.

Think About This:

If you could only hear or smell instead of see, how different would your world be?

Verification Door

Why is the red ruffed lemur in danger even though it looks strong and healthy?

It lives in only one small forest. When that forest shrinks, the whole species has nowhere else to go.

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.